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| Inventor(s)          | Blackburn; Christopher William et al. |

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### Communication system having bypass connector assemblies for mating with an active module

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#### Abstract

A communication system includes a cartridge having panels forming a chamber. The panels include a first panel and a second panel different than the first panel. The cartridge includes first openings in the first panel and second openings in the second panel. The communication system includes cable connector assemblies received in the first openings. Each cable connector assembly includes a cable connector and cables extending from the cable connector. The cables define data channels. The communication system includes bypass connector assemblies received in the second openings. Each bypass connector assembly includes a bypass connector connected to the cables of the corresponding cable connector assemblies. An active module is coupled to the corresponding bypass connector assemblies. The active module includes a repeater device restoring signals transmitting along the data channels.

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## Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims benefit to U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/504,001, filed 24-May-2023, titled “COMMUNICATION SYSTEM HAVING BYPASS CONNECTOR ASSEMBLIES FOR MATING WITH AN ACTIVE MODULE”, the subject matter of which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.

### BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(1) The subject matter herein relates generally to communication systems.

(2) Cable assemblies are used to electrically connect various components within a system, such as a server or network system. The cable assemblies extend between the components, such as network, compute, storage, memory, or other components. The components may be arranged in shelves or trays of a network rack. Some systems may include components such as cards, such as line cards, daughter cards, mother boards, and the like. Each cable assembly includes multiple cables arranged in a bundle or array. Each cable forms a data channel. However, high speed channel budgets are decreasing as speeds increase, which results in shorter allowable cable lengths. Some systems utilize active devices, such as re-drivers or re-timers at the component interfaces to extend cable reach and enable smaller cable diameters. However, the cable lengths are limited at high data speeds. Additionally, incorporating the active devices at the component interfaces may be a less than ideal location for the active devices along the data channel. Repair and replacement of the active devices is also difficult when the active devices are incorporated into the component interfaces.

### BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

(3) In one embodiment, a communication system is provided and includes a cartridge having panels

forming a chamber. The panels include a first panel and a second panel different than the first panel. The cartridge includes first openings in the first panel and second openings in the second panel. The communication system includes cable connector assemblies received in the first openings. Each cable connector assembly includes a cable connector and cables extending from the cable connector. The cables define data channels. The communication system includes bypass connector assemblies received in the second openings. Each bypass connector assembly includes a bypass connector connected to the cables of the corresponding cable connector assemblies. An active module is coupled to the corresponding bypass connector assemblies. The active module includes a repeater device restoring signals transmitting along the data channels.

(4) In another embodiment, a communication system is provided and includes a cartridge having panels forming a chamber. The panels include a first panel and a second panel different than the first panel. The cartridge includes first openings in the first panel and second openings in the second panel. The communication system includes cable connector assemblies received in the first openings. Each cable connector assembly includes a cable connector and cables extending from the cable connector. The cables define data channels. The communication system includes bypass connector assemblies received in the second openings. Each bypass connector assembly includes a bypass connector connected to the cables of the corresponding cable connector assemblies. The communication system includes an active module removably coupled to the corresponding bypass connector assemblies. The active module includes a module circuit board, a first module connector mounted to the module circuit board, a second module connector mounted to the module circuit board, and a repeater device mounted to the module circuit board. The first and second module connectors being mated to the corresponding bypass connectors. The repeater device is located inline between the first and second module connectors. The repeater device restoring signals transmitting along the data channels.

(5) In a further embodiment, a communication system is provided and includes a cartridge having panels forming a chamber. The panels include a first panel and a second panel different than the first panel. The cartridge includes first openings in the first panel and second openings in the second panel. The communication system includes cable connector assemblies received in the first openings. Each cable connector assembly includes a cable connector and cables extending from the cable connector. The cable connector includes signal contacts terminated to ends of the cables. The cable connector having a mating end configured to be mated to a mating connector assembly. The signal contacts and the cables define data channels. The communication system includes bypass connector assemblies received in the second openings. Each bypass connector assembly includes a bypass connector. The bypass connector includes bypass contacts terminated to ends of the corresponding cables. The bypass connector includes a separable mating interface configured to be mated to an active component having a repeater device to restore signals transmitting along the data channels.

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## Description

### BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 illustrates a communication system in accordance with an exemplary embodiment.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of a portion of the communication system showing one of the mating connector assemblies poised for coupling to the corresponding cable connector assembly in accordance with an exemplary embodiment.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a front perspective view of a portion of the communication system showing one of the cable connector assemblies coupled to the cartridge in accordance with an exemplary embodiment.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a front perspective view of a portion of the communication system showing one of the active modules poised for coupling to the corresponding bypass connector assemblies in

accordance with an exemplary embodiment.

(5) FIG. 5 is a rear perspective view of a portion of the communication system with a portion of the cartridge removed to illustrate the internal components of the communication system in accordance with an exemplary embodiment.

(6) FIG. 6 is a front perspective view of a portion of the communication system showing one of the active modules poised for coupling to the corresponding bypass connector assemblies at the first side of the cartridge in accordance with an exemplary embodiment.

(7) FIG. 7 is a front perspective view of a portion of the communication system showing the bypass connector assemblies at the second side of the cartridge in accordance with an exemplary embodiment.

(8) FIG. 8 is an exploded view of the communication system in accordance with an exemplary embodiment showing a cooling system for cooling the active modules.

(9) FIG. 9 is an assembled view of the communication system showing the cooling system in accordance with an exemplary embodiment.

(10) FIG. 10 is a front view of the communication system showing the cooling system in accordance with an exemplary embodiment.

(11) FIG. 11 is an exploded view of the communication system in accordance with an exemplary embodiment showing a cooling system for cooling the active modules.

(12) FIG. 12 is an assembled view of the communication system showing the cooling system in accordance with an exemplary embodiment.

(13) FIG. 13 is a front view of the communication system showing the cooling system in accordance with an exemplary embodiment.

#### DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

(14) FIG. 1 illustrates a communication system **100** in accordance with an exemplary embodiment. The communication system **100** includes at least one cable connector assembly **102** and at least one mating connector assembly **104** mated with the corresponding at least one cable connector assembly **102**. In the illustrated embodiment, each mating connector assembly **104** includes a mating electrical connector **106** mounted to a circuit board **108**, such as a backplane, a daughter card, a network switch, and the like. In various embodiments, the communication system **100** may include an equipment rack or chassis that supports the circuit boards **108**. The circuit boards **108** may be pluggable into the equipment rack or chassis to mate the mating electrical connector **106** with the corresponding cable connector assembly **102**.

(15) The communication system **100** includes at least one bypass connector assembly **200** and at least one active module **300** coupled to the corresponding bypass connector assemblies **200**. The active modules **300** provides active signaling for the signals or data channels passing through the communication system. The active modules **300** are electrically coupled to the cables of the cable connector assemblies **102** through the bypass connector assemblies **200**. The active modules **300** restore or enhance the signals transmitted along the data channels. The active modules **300** may be connected between any of the various cable connector assemblies **102**. Optionally, the active modules **300** may be connected to multiple cable connector assemblies **102**.

(16) In an exemplary embodiment, the communication system **100** includes a cabinet or cartridge **110** that holds the cable connector assemblies **102**. The cartridge **110** may be coupled to the rack or chassis that receives the circuit boards **108**. The cartridge **110** forms an enclosed space or chamber **111** for the cable connector assemblies **102** and cables **150** (shown in FIG. 5) extending from the cable connector assemblies **102**. The cables **150** may be routed within the enclosed space formed by the cartridge **110** to electrically connect between the various cable connector assemblies **102**.

(17) In an exemplary embodiment, the cartridge **110** is formed from a plurality of panels **112**, such as sheet metal panels. The cartridge **110** includes a front panel **114**, side panels **116**, and a rear panel **118**. The panels **112** may additionally include an upper panel and/or a lower panel. The cable connector assemblies **102** are provided at the front panel **114** for mating with the mating electrical

connectors **106**. In an exemplary embodiment, the cable connector assemblies **102** are arranged in a column along the front panel **114**. Optionally, the cable connector assemblies **102** may be provided in multiple columns. The mating electrical connectors **106** are external to the cartridge **110**. The bypass connector assemblies **200** are provided at a different panel, such as one or both of the side panels **116** or the rear panel **118** for mating with the active module **300**. The active module **300** is external to the cartridge **110**. In an exemplary embodiment, the bypass connector assemblies **200** are arranged in a column along the side panel **116**. Optionally, the bypass connector assemblies **200** may be provided in multiple columns.

(18) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of a portion of the communication system **100** showing one of the mating connector assemblies **104** poised for coupling to the corresponding cable connector assembly **102**. In the illustrated embodiment, the mating connector assembly **104** is a network component. For example, the mating connector assembly **104** may be a compute node, a memory module, a network switch, a storage device, a network accelerator, or another type of communication component. The mating connector assembly **104** may be a backplane component or a daughtercard component.

(19) In an exemplary embodiment, the mating electrical connector **106** of the mating connector assembly **104** is mounted to a front edge of the circuit board **108**. The mating electrical connector **106** includes a connector housing **190** holding signal contacts (not shown). The signal contacts are terminated to the circuit board **108**. The signal contacts may be socket contacts. The mating electrical connector **106** may include shields providing shielding for the signal contacts.

(20) The cable connector assembly **102** is received in the cartridge **110**. The cable connector assembly **102** is provided at the front panel **114** for mating with the mating connector assembly **104** along a mating axis **126**. The connector assemblies **102**, **300** are configured to transmit and/or receive data through an interface. The connector assemblies **102**, **300** may include connectors, such as plug or receptacle connectors.

(21) In an exemplary embodiment, a mating guide **120** is provided to guide mating of the mating electrical connector **106** with the cable connector assembly **102**. In the illustrated embodiment, the mating guide **120** includes a guide post extending forward of the mating ends of the cable connector assembly **102**. The mating guide **120** may be used to align the connectors in one or more lateral directions transverse to the mating axis **126**, such as in a horizontal direction and/or a vertical direction. Other types of guide features may be used in alternative embodiments.

(22) FIG. 3 is a front perspective view of a portion of the communication system **100** showing one of the cable connector assemblies **102** coupled to the cartridge **110**. The cable connector assembly **102** includes a cable connector **130**. The mating end of the cable connector **130** passes through an opening **128** in the front panel **114** for mating with the mating electrical connector **106** (FIG. 2).

(23) The cable connector **130** includes a connector housing **132** holding contact assemblies **140**. The connector housing **132** includes a cavity **134** that receives the mating end of the mating electrical connector **106**. The contact assemblies **140** are arranged in the cavity **134**, such as in rows and columns. The walls of the connector housing **132** may be chamfered and have a lead-in surfaces to guide mating of the mating electrical connector **106** in the cavity **134**. The connector housing **132** may have guide features to properly position the mating electrical connector **106** within the cavity **134**.

(24) Each contact assembly **140** includes at least one signal contact **142**, which is configured to be electrically connected to a corresponding conductor of a cable **150** extending from the cable connector **130**. In the illustrated embodiment, each contact assembly **140** includes a pair of the signal contacts **142**, which define a differential pair. In various embodiments, the signal contacts **142** may be pin contacts. However, in alternative embodiments, the signal contacts **142** may be socket contacts, spring beam contacts, or other types of contacts. The signal contacts **142** may be stamped and formed contacts. Each contact assembly **140** includes a shield **144** provide electrical shielding for the signal contacts **142**. The shield **144** is configured to be electrically connected to

the cable shield of the cable **150**. In the illustrated embodiment, the shield **144** is C-shaped providing electrical shielding on three sides of the pair of signal contacts **142**. The shield **144** may have other shapes in alternative embodiments. The shield **144** may be a stamped and formed shield. (25) FIG. **4** is a front perspective view of a portion of the communication system **100** showing one of the active modules **300** poised for coupling to the corresponding bypass connector assemblies **200**. FIG. **5** is a rear perspective view of a portion of the communication system **100** with a portion of the cartridge **110** removed to illustrate the internal components of the communication system **100**.

(26) The cable connector assemblies **102** are arranged at the front panel **114**. The bypass connector assemblies **200** are arranged along the side panel **116**. The bypass connector assemblies **200** may be movable relative to the side panel **116** (for example, horizontally and/or vertically) to align for mating with the active module **300**. For example, a spring-loaded mounting bracket may hold the bypass connector assembly **200** relative to the side panel **116**. The bypass connector assemblies **200** provide an additional mating interface for the communication system **100** on the side of the cartridge **100**. The active modules **300** are coupled to the bypass connector assemblies **200** at the side panel **116**. The cables **150** extend from the cable connectors **130**. The cables **150** are routed between the various cable connectors **130**. For example, at least some of the cables **150** may be routed directly from one cable connector **130** to another cable connector **130**. In an exemplary embodiment, at least some of the cables **150** are routed from the cable connectors **130** to the bypass connector assemblies **200**. The data channels of such cables **150** are processed by the active modules **300** to provide active signaling for the signals, such as to restore or enhance the signals transmitted along the data channels. The communication system **100** may have any combination of passive and active links between the mating connector assemblies **104**. For example, a first subset of the cables **150** may be routed to the corresponding bypass connector assemblies **200** and a second subset of the cables **150** may be routed directly between different cable connector assemblies **102**.

(27) In an exemplary embodiment, each cable **150** is a twinaxial cable having a first conductor and a second conductor in a core of the cable **150**. The cables **150** extend between a first end **160** and a second end **162**. The first end **160** is configured to be coupled to a first cable connector **130** and the second end **162** is configured to be coupled to a second cable connector **130**. Optionally, some of the cables **150** may be continuous between the first end **160** and the second end **162** (for example, single cable). Optionally, some of the cables **150** may be split at an intermediate location into different cable sections to bypass the data channels through the active module **300**. For example, the active module **300** is located remote from the first end **160** and is located remote from the second end **162**. Such cables **150** include first sections **166** between the first end **160** and the active module **300** and second sections **168** between the second end **162** and the active module **300**.

(28) In various embodiments, the intermediate location may be approximately centered between the first and second ends **160**, **162**. For example, the first and second sections **166**, **168** may have approximately equal lengths. In other embodiments, the intermediate location may be located closer to one of the ends, such as closer to the first end **160** or closer to the second end **162** such that the first and second sections **166**, **168** have different lengths. The intermediate location **164** may be selected based on channel lengths of the transmission lines, such as being located near an end of an allowable channel length per protocol specification, such as PCIe, Ethernet, Infiniband, NVlink, and the like.

(29) Each bypass connector assembly **200** includes a bypass connector **230** coupled to the cartridge **110**, such as at the side panel **116**. The mating end of the bypass connector **230** passes through an opening **228** in the side panel **116** for mating with the active module **300**. The bypass connector **230** includes a connector housing **232** holding contact assemblies **240**. The connector housing **232** includes a cavity **234**. The contact assemblies **240** are arranged in the cavity **234**, such as in rows and columns. The walls of the connector housing **232** may be chamfered and have a lead-in

surfaces. The connector housing **232** may have guide features to guide mating with the active module **300**.

(30) Each contact assembly **240** includes at least one signal contact **242**, which is configured to be electrically connected to the conductor of the corresponding cable **150**. In the illustrated embodiment, each contact assembly **240** includes a pair of the signal contacts **242**, which define a differential pair. In various embodiments, the signal contacts **242** may be pin contacts. However, in alternative embodiments, the signal contacts **242** may be socket contacts, spring beam contacts, or other types of contacts. The signal contacts **242** may be stamped and formed contacts. Each contact assembly **240** may include shields to provide electrical shielding for the signal contacts **242**.

(31) In an exemplary embodiment, the active module **300** includes one or more repeater devices **302** to restore signals transmitted along the data channels of the corresponding cables **150**. The active modules **300** can be strategically placed and the cables can be strategically routed to connect to corresponding active modules **300** to meet budget constraints on the data channels. In the illustrated embodiment, the active module **300** includes three of the repeater devices **302**; however, the active module **300** may include greater or fewer repeater devices **302** in alternative embodiments. Each repeater device **302** includes an integrated circuit. The repeater device **302** operates as a channel reach extension device to extend the transmission line length along the data channels. For example, when the channel length of the data channel between the cable connectors **130** is longer than an allowable channel length, such as per protocol specifications, the repeater device **302** restores the signals by bypassing the data channels through the active module **300** such that the distance between the cable connectors **130** and the repeater device **302** is shorter than the allowable channel length. The repeater device **302** allows reliable, error-free communication for the communication system **100**. The repeater device **302** is configured to restore the signals at some point midway between the cable connectors **130**. The active modules **300** and repeater devices **302** are at the exterior such that the active modules **300** are serviceable and may be field replaceable. The repeater devices **302** are exposed at the exterior of the cartridge **110**, such as for active or passive cooling of the repeater devices **302**.

(32) The repeater device **302** may be a re-timer device in various embodiments. In various embodiments, the re-timer device may be an x-16 re-timer device having sixteen channels. The re-timer device is configured to retransmit a fresh copy of the original signal. The re-timer device may be a mixed signal analog/digital device that is protocol-aware and has the ability to fully recover the data, extract the embedded clock and retransmit a fresh copy of the data using a clean clock. The re-timer device may include a continuous time linear equalizer (CTLE) and a wideband gain stage. The re-timer device may include a clock and data recovery (CDR) circuit, a decision feedback equalizer (DFE) and a transmit (Tx) finite impulse response (FIR) driver. The re-timer device may include a finite state machines (FSMs) and/or a microcontroller to manage the automatic adaptation of the CTLE, wideband gain, DFE and FIR driver, and implement a link training and status state machine (LTSSM). The re-timer device may actively participate in the protocol. The re-timer device may fully recover the data stream and retransmit the data signal on a clean clock to enable extension of the channel to twice the original specification. The DFE of the re-timer device compensates for reflections in the channel response caused by impedance discontinuities in board vias, connectors and package socket-board interfaces along the data transmission line. The re-timer device may examine the received signal and adjust the CTLE and DFE to minimize the bit error rate (BER). The transmitter of the re-timer device may adjust de-emphasis and pre-shoot equalization to minimize BER according to equalization protocol. The re-timer device may have tools for assessing the electrical performance (internal eye monitors, pattern generators, pattern checkers) and protocol performance (link state history monitors, timeout adjustments). The re-timer device may compensate and reset any lane-to-lane skew, effectively doubling the specification budget.

(33) The repeater device **302** may be a re-driver device in various embodiments. The re-driver

device is configured to amplify the signal that is transmitted downstream of the re-driver device. The re-driver device may be an analog reach extension device designed to boost the high-frequency portions of the signal, such as to counteract frequency-dependent attenuation along the data channel. The re-driver device may include a continuous time linear equalizer (CTLE), a wideband gain stage and a linear driver. The re-driver device may include receive (RX) side equalizer (EQ) to compensate for frequency-dependent attenuation due to PCB traces or cable conductors along the transmission line. The CTLE may function to open the closed eye of the distorted waveform. The transmit (TX) side of the re-driver device may include a pre-emphasis function (transmit equalizer) to pre-shape the transmit waveform.

(34) The active module **300** includes a module circuit board **310** having a first end **312** and a second end **314**. The module circuit board **310** includes an inner surface **316** and an outer surface **318**. The integrated circuit may be provided at the outer surface **318** or the inner surface **316** and connected to circuits of the module circuit board **310**. Other electrical components may be mounted to the module circuit board **310** at the inner surface **316** and/or the outer surface **318**, such as capacitors, transistors, resistors, memory components, microcontrollers, EEPROM devices, and the like.

(35) The active module **300** includes at least one module connector **330** coupled to the module circuit board **310** for mating with the corresponding bypass connectors **230**. In the illustrated embodiment, each active module **300** includes two of the module connectors **330**, which may be electrically connected by traces or circuits of the module circuit board **310**. The module connectors **330** are provided at the inner surface **316** of the module circuit board **310** to face the cartridge **110**. The mating end of the module connector **330** is configured to be mated with the mating end of the corresponding bypass connector **230**. The mating end defines a separable mating interface to allow removal of the module connector **330** and the active module **300**. Guide elements, such as guide pins, may extend from the module circuit board **310** or the module connectors **330** to guide mating with the bypass connectors **230**. The module connector **330** includes a connector housing **332** holding contact assemblies **340**. The connector housing **332** includes a cavity **334**. The contact assemblies **340** are arranged in the cavity **334**, such as in rows and columns. The walls of the connector housing **332** may be chamfered and have a lead-in surfaces for mating with the bypass connector **230**. The connector housing **332** may have guide features (for example, guide pins) to guide mating with the bypass connector **230**.

(36) Each contact assembly **340** includes at least one signal contact **342**, which is configured to be electrically connected to the signal contact **242** of the bypass connector **230**. The signal contact **342** is configured to be terminated to the module circuit board **310**, such as being soldered or press fit to the module circuit board **310**. In the illustrated embodiment, each contact assembly **340** includes a pair of the signal contacts **342**, which define a differential pair. In various embodiments, the signal contacts **342** may be pin contacts. However, in alternative embodiments, the signal contacts **342** may be socket contacts, spring beam contacts, or other types of contacts. The signal contacts **342** may be stamped and formed contacts. Each contact assembly **340** may include shields to provide electrical shielding for the signal contacts **342**.

(37) In an exemplary embodiment, the communication system **100** includes a power assembly **350** for supplying power to the active modules **300**. The power assembly **350** may include a wire harness or busbar with power connectors coupled to the active modules **300** to supply power to the active modules **300**. In other various embodiments, the power assembly **350** supplies power directly to the module connectors **330**, such as through the bypass connectors **230**. The power may be supplied by corresponding power cables. The power cables may extend from the cable connectors **130**. For example, the power may be supplied by the mating connector assembly **104**. The power assembly **350** may be located within the chamber **111** of the cartridge **110**. Alternatively, the power assembly **350** may be located exterior of the cartridge **110**, such as being routed along the panels **112**.



(38) FIG. 6 is a front perspective view of a portion of the communication system **100** showing one of the active modules **300** poised for coupling to the corresponding bypass connector assemblies **200** at the first side **116** of the cartridge **110**. FIG. 7 is a front perspective view of a portion of the communication system **100** showing the bypass connector assemblies **200** at the second side panel **116** of the cartridge **110**.

(39) The active modules **300** shown in FIG. 6 are smaller than the active modules **300** shown in FIG. 4. For example, the module circuit card **310** is smaller (for example, shorter and narrower than the embodiment of FIG. 4). In the illustrated embodiment, the active module **300** includes a single repeater device **302** rather than multiple repeater devices **302**. In the illustrated embodiment, the module connectors **330** and the bypass connectors **230** are smaller and may include fewer signal contacts. In an exemplary embodiment, the bypass connectors **230** are arranged in offset pairs (for example, offset front to rear) to allow offset placement of the active modules **300**. Offsetting the bypass connectors **230** allows tighter placement of the active modules **300**.

(40) FIG. 8 is an exploded view of the communication system **100** in accordance with an exemplary embodiment showing a cooling system **400** for cooling the active modules **300**. FIG. 9 is an assembled view of the communication system **100** showing the cooling system **400** in accordance with an exemplary embodiment. FIG. 10 is a front view of the communication system **100** showing the cooling system **400** in accordance with an exemplary embodiment.

(41) In an exemplary embodiment, the cooling system **400** includes a cold plate **402** having a cooling channel **404**. Cooling fluid may be passed through the cooling channel **404** to enhance heat dissipation. The cold plate may be manufactured from a thermally conductive material, such as a metal material (for example, aluminum). The cold plate **402** is thermally coupled to the repeater devices **302** to dissipate heat from the repeater devices **302**.

(42) FIG. 11 is an exploded view of the communication system **100** in accordance with an exemplary embodiment showing a cooling system **500** for cooling the active modules **300**. FIG. 12 is an assembled view of the communication system **100** showing the cooling system **500** in accordance with an exemplary embodiment. FIG. 13 is a front view of the communication system **100** showing the cooling system **500** in accordance with an exemplary embodiment.

(43) In an exemplary embodiment, the cooling system **500** includes heatsinks **502** for dissipating heat from the active modules **300**. The heatsink **502** includes a base **504** thermally coupled to the repeater devices **302** and heat dissipating fins **506** extending from the base **504**. Fans may be used to enhance airflow over the heat dissipating fins **506** to improve heat dissipation.

(44) It is to be understood that the above description is intended to be illustrative, and not restrictive. For example, the above-described embodiments (and/or aspects thereof) may be used in combination with each other. In addition, many modifications may be made to adapt a particular situation or material to the teachings of the invention without departing from its scope.

Dimensions, types of materials, orientations of the various components, and the number and positions of the various components described herein are intended to define parameters of certain embodiments, and are by no means limiting and are merely exemplary embodiments. Many other embodiments and modifications within the spirit and scope of the claims will be apparent to those of skill in the art upon reviewing the above description. The scope of the invention should, therefore, be determined with reference to the appended claims, along with the full scope of equivalents to which such claims are entitled. In the appended claims, the terms “including” and “in which” are used as the plain-English equivalents of the respective terms “comprising” and “wherein.” Moreover, in the following claims, the terms “first,” “second,” and “third,” etc. are used merely as labels, and are not intended to impose numerical requirements on their objects. Further, the limitations of the following claims are not written in means-plus-function format and are not intended to be interpreted based on 35 U.S.C. § 112 (f), unless and until such claim limitations expressly use the phrase “means for” followed by a statement of function void of further structure.

## Claims

1. A communication system comprising: a cartridge having panels forming a chamber, the panels including a first panel and a second panel different than the first panel, the cartridge including first openings in the first panel and second openings in the second panel; cable connector assemblies received in the first openings, each cable connector assembly including a cable connector and cables extending from the cable connector, the cables defining data channels; bypass connector assemblies received in the second openings, each bypass connector assembly including a bypass connector connected to the cables of the corresponding cable connector assemblies; and an active module coupled to the corresponding bypass connector assemblies, the active module including a repeater device restoring signals transmitting along the data channels.
2. The communication system of claim 1, wherein each bypass connector includes a separable mating interface, the active module being removably coupled to the bypass connectors at the separable mating interfaces.
3. The communication system of claim 1, wherein the repeater device is located inline between the corresponding bypass connector assemblies.
4. The communication system of claim 1, wherein the active module includes a module circuit board, a first module connector mounted to the module circuit board, and a second module connector mounted to the module circuit board, the repeater device being mounted to the module circuit board inline between the first and second module connectors, the first and second module connectors being mated to the corresponding bypass connectors.
5. The communication system of claim 1, wherein the cables extend between a first end configured to be coupled to a first cable connector of the cable connectors and a second end configured to be coupled to a second cable connector of the cable connectors, the cable including a first portion extending to the first end and a second portion extending to the second end, the first portion being coupled to a first bypass connector of the bypass connectors, the second portion being coupled a second bypass connector of the bypass connectors.
6. The communication system of claim 1, wherein the active module is located along the data channels remote from the cable connectors of the cable connector assemblies.
7. The communication system of claim 1, wherein the first panel is a front panel at a front of the cartridge, the second panel is a side panel at a side of the cartridge, the cable connectors having forward facing mating ends, the bypass connectors having mating ends facing in a direction perpendicular to the forward facing mating ends of the cable connectors.
8. The communication system of claim 1, wherein each cable connector assembly includes a plurality of the cables extending from the cable connector, wherein a first subset of the cables are routed to the corresponding bypass connector assemblies and a second subset of the cables are routed to different cable connector assemblies.
9. The communication system of claim 1, further comprising a power assembly supplying power to the active module.
10. The communication system of claim 1, further comprising a cooling assembly thermally coupled to the active module to dissipate heat from the active module.
11. The communication system of claim 1, wherein the active module is a first active module, the communication system further comprising a second active module, the first and second active modules being coupled to different bypass connector assemblies.
12. A communication system comprising: a cartridge having panels forming a chamber, the panels including a first panel and a second panel different than the first panel, the cartridge including first openings in the first panel and second openings in the second panel; cable connector assemblies received in the first openings, each cable connector assembly including a cable connector and cables extending from the cable connector, the cables defining data channels; bypass connector

assemblies received in the second openings, each bypass connector assembly including a bypass connector connected to the cables of the corresponding cable connector assemblies; and an active module removably coupled to the corresponding bypass connector assemblies, the active module includes a module circuit board, a first module connector mounted to the module circuit board, a second module connector mounted to the module circuit board, and a repeater device mounted to the module circuit board, the first and second module connectors being mated to the corresponding bypass connectors, the repeater device located inline between the first and second module connectors, the repeater device restoring signals transmitting along the data channels.

13. The communication system of claim 12, wherein the repeater device is located inline between the corresponding bypass connector assemblies.

14. The communication system of claim 12, wherein the active module is located along the data channels remote from the cable connectors of the cable connector assemblies.

15. The communication system of claim 12, wherein the first panel is a front panel at a front of the cartridge, the second panel is a side panel at a side of the cartridge, the active module being coupled to the bypass connectors at the side of the cartridge.

16. The communication system of claim 12, further comprising a power assembly supplying power to the active module.

17. The communication system of claim 12, further comprising a cooling assembly thermally coupled to the active module to dissipate heat from the active module.

18. A communication system comprising: a cartridge having panels forming a chamber, the panels including a first panel and a second panel different than the first panel, the cartridge including first openings in the first panel and second openings in the second panel; cable connector assemblies received in the first openings, each cable connector assembly including a cable connector and cables extending from the cable connector, the cable connector including signal contacts terminated to ends of the cables, the cable connector having a mating end configured to be mated to a mating connector assembly, the signal contacts and the cables defining data channels; bypass connector assemblies received in the second openings, each bypass connector assembly including a bypass connector, the bypass connector including bypass contacts terminated to ends of the corresponding cables, the bypass connector including a separable mating interface configured to be mated to an active component having a repeater device to restore signals transmitting along the data channels.

19. The communication system of claim 18, wherein the cables extend between a first end configured to be coupled to a first cable connector of the cable connectors and a second end configured to be coupled to a second cable connector of the cable connectors, the cable including a first portion extending to the first end and a second portion extending to the second end, the first portion being coupled to a first bypass connector of the bypass connectors, the second portion being coupled a second bypass connector of the bypass connectors.

20. The communication system of claim 18, wherein the first panel is a front panel at a front of the cartridge, the second panel is a side panel at a side of the cartridge, the cable connectors having forward facing mating ends, the bypass connectors having mating ends facing in a direction perpendicular to the forward facing mating ends of the cable connectors.

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